

RISK vs. REWARD — Introduction & Project Overview

Tagline

How much would you bet you're right?

Concept Overview

RISK vs. REWARD is a high-stakes trivia game show where confidence is as important as knowledge.

In the standard one-hour format, two contestants each play a complete, independent 12-question game, competing against the questions and their own decisions—not against each other.

Contestants face multiple-choice questions, but answering correctly is only part of the challenge. After seeing the question and its four possible answers, they must decide how much they trust their choice using a dynamic RISK/REWARD Slider.

That decision determines how much they can win—or lose—on the current question and influences how much they can still win later in the game.

The ultimate prize: \$1,000,000.

The ultimate challenge: there is no option to walk away.

Every confidence decision carries consequences. Contestants must constantly balance what they know with how sure they are that they know it. Two equally knowledgeable players can finish with dramatically different outcomes based entirely on how they manage confidence, risk, and pressure throughout the game.

As the stakes rise, knowledge, strategy, and psychology collide in a format where a single decision can reshape a contestant's path to the million-dollar top prize.

Key Features

- **12 Questions. \$1,000,000 Top Prize.** Each contestant plays a complete game with the potential to win up to one million dollars.
- **Two Independent Contestants.** The standard one-hour format features two separate games, showcasing contrasting personalities and strategies.
- **No Walkaways.** Every contestant must complete all 12 questions.
- **Real-Time Confidence Decisions.** Contestants see the question and four possible answers before deciding how much to risk.
- **Visible Financial Consequences.** The slider updates potential gains, losses, and best- and worst-case final totals in real time.

- **The Do-Over Lifeline.** One opportunity to replace a question during the first six rounds. If unused, it becomes a final-question advantage: a choice between two categories.
- **Psychological Tension.** Contestants constantly manage what they know and how sure they are that they know it.
- **Built-In Audience Participation.** Every question creates a second game at home: not just "Do I know the answer?" but "How much would I risk on being right?"

The format can also support a half-hour syndicated version featuring one contestant per episode and a Couples Edition in which partners make decisions together.

Tone & Style

RISK vs. REWARD combines high-stakes suspense with humor, personality, and human drama.

Guided by an engaging host, the show balances strategic decision-making with emotional storytelling as contestants face increasingly consequential choices under pressure.

The host helps viewers understand not only whether contestants know the answers, but how their confidence decisions affect the money at stake and the possibilities that remain.

The result is a format that can deliver exciting wins, costly mistakes, unexpected comebacks, and memorable contestant reactions.

Audience Appeal

- Appeals to trivia fans, strategy gamers, risk-takers, and casual viewers alike.
- Encourages viewers to compare their own confidence and decision-making with the contestants' choices.
- Creates natural opportunities for social conversation, debate, and repeat engagement.
- Offers contrasting contestant personalities and strategies within the standard one-hour episode.
- Combines accessible multiple-choice trivia with a distinctive layer of strategic decision-making.

Why Now?

In a crowded game show landscape, RISK vs. REWARD offers a distinctive twist on the trivia format by making confidence a visible and meaningful part of the game.

Contestants do not simply answer questions—they decide how much they trust their answers after seeing the available choices and before committing to a result.

This creates psychological tension, strategic depth, and highly personal gameplay while keeping the central question easy for audiences to understand.

The interactive prototype also demonstrates how the slider, changing financial consequences, and contestant decisions can work together in real time.

Final Thought

Knowledge gets you in the game. Confidence determines how far you go.

RISK vs. REWARD transforms trivia into a compelling test of decision-making under pressure, where every answer matters—but every confidence decision matters even more.

The question isn't just whether you're right.

It's how much you'd bet you are.

Interactive Demo

Experience the format firsthand with a fully interactive prototype.

Players select categories, view questions and answers, and adjust the RISK/REWARD Slider while watching potential outcomes update in real time.

Play the interactive demo: <https://eddielawhorn.com/risk-vs-reward/game>

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